Human-made Things in the Bible © United Bible Societies, 2025. Adapted from: The Works of Their Hands: Man-made Things in the Bible, by Ray Pritz © 2009 United Bible Societies. This work is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/).

Figurehead

8.1.10 Figurehead

Reference:

Greek παράσημος (parasēmos) ACT 28:11

Description and usage:

The figurehead was an identifying emblem, often a carved figure, mounted on the prow of a ship. It was made of wood.

Translation:

When translating the literal expression “figurehead of the Twin Gods” in ACT 28:11, it may be possible to use a phrase such as “carving of the heads of the Twin Gods” or “statue of the Twin Gods.”